Week 10

JOURNEY

JOURNEY: ADVOCATES® · LEADER HANDOUT · UNIT 3 · LESSON 2

Universe

BIG IDEA

Genesis tells us God designed the world, and nature says the same thing: the earth is fine-tuned, set just so for life to survive and thrive. That fine-tuning shows more than a God who exists; it shows a God who lovingly made a home for us.

Key points from the Leader Video

1. The bottle flip looks like pure luck, but it's really fine-tuning: the right bottle, the right amount of water and the right spin make it land every time.
2. Genesis tells us God created and designed the world. But even without Scripture, nature itself tells us the same thing about God's design.
3. The atmosphere, the earth's rotation and its distance from the sun are set just so for life. Is that random chance, or a well-crafted design by God?
4. Did the universe just restart over and over until it worked, like flipping a bottle enough times? This lesson looks for real design behind the conditions for life.
5. This week's one word is thinking. Last week said science furthers faith; now students start putting the pieces together for themselves.
6. Fine-tuning shows more than a habitable planet: God made a home for us, with his heart and love in mind. Ask what that says about his character.

SCRIPTURE IN THE VIDEO

Genesis

FOR YOU

Before club: think it through yourself.

1. What does the care built into creation tell me about God's character?
2. Which parts of the natural world do I take for granted that I could stop and consider this week?
3. How can I help students think the pieces through, not just hear the conclusions?

ASK YOUR GROUP

In small group: questions to ask your students.

1. What did the bottle flip show you about the difference between luck and fine-tuning?
2. If you didn't have the Bible, what could nature alone tell you about whether there's a designer?
3. Which seems harder for you to believe, random chance or design, and why?
4. What does it mean to you that God made the earth a home, not just a place to survive?
5. What questions about the universe and God are you still working through?

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WEEK 10 · LEADER VIDEO

The full transcript

The talk from this week's Leader Video, lightly edited for reading. Times point back to that moment in the video.

The bottle flip

0:05 Probably a year ago this became really popular, right — this little bottle flip thing, where you just flip a bottle and it's supposed to drop if you do it just right, like that. What's fascinating is that it seems like this is a huge thing of luck. I can just sit here and do this all day long, right? It's just this massive thing of luck, that I just happen to be getting lucky when I actually get the bottle to flip correctly. But the reality is that's not necessarily luck. Apparently it's not skill on the part of myself either. However, after a little bit of research, you find that this is actually more of a fine-tuning thing.

0:49 There's actually science behind the bottle flip. It has something to do with the size of the water bottle — this one being much too small — the amount of water that's in the bottle, and how much spin you actually put on it. If you get it right every single time, and you have just the right amount of spin, and just the right amount of water, and just the right bottle, you can never miss. Based on science, it'll always land the way it's supposed to. See?

What if we had no Scripture

1:23 We learned from Genesis that this world was created by God. We know that, right? And we know that God designed it for us. But what if we really didn't have Scripture to tell us that? I mean, this tells me that God designed the world. This tells me that God did it all, and all I have to do is look at this and go, "Yeah, okay, I know that." But what if I didn't have it? What does this tell me about God's design? What it tells me is the same thing that nature tells us.

1:59 All of this fine-tuning, all of these things that we have — just right, just calculated just so, so that we could actually survive here, so that we could thrive, so we could live and breathe and do all the things that we do. And so we could have this earth spinning in this universe around the sun, in all the ways that most of us kind of just accept and take for granted and don't worry too much about. Is this really about random chance?

Random chance or design

2:29 Did this world just sort of pop into existence, and things just happened to fall in the right way — that if I flip this bottle enough times, this universe just kept starting and restarting and restarting and restarting, until one day it actually worked? And see, there it is, now the universe worked. Is that what this is, or is this a well-crafted design by God?

2:55 That's what this unit is about, and that's what this lesson is about. This lesson is about looking at our universe and seeing that this is more than just a random whole bunch of stuff that happened to fall into place, the right place at the right time, but instead an actual design and

science behind crafting the right conditions for life to happen. So for this week, I want you to think about one word. I want you to think about thinking.

Science and faith together

3:32 Last week we kind of introduced the idea that science actually furthers our faith and lays a crucial foundation for what we believe. It's great. Well, this is where we start to see that happen. This is where we start to actually have to think about some of these things and start putting some pieces together. Think about more than just the thinking, cognitive piece of this and the stuff that you can know. But take a second and think through this for a second.

A place made for us

4:05 What does it mean that God has made a place for us? If you stop and consider this for just one minute — all of these things, whether the atmosphere, the earth's rotation, the distance from the sun, whatever it is. These things are just so, so that we can live here, so that we can thrive here. If God designed this, it doesn't just prove or show evidence that God exists. It doesn't just prove that God gave us a place that's habitable, a place for us to actually just survive here.

4:39 But it's made in such a way that God has created a home for us. And he did it with his heart, and with love in mind. I mean, what does this say about who God is? What does fine-tuning say about the character of God?